

Number	Reference	Question	Answer
1	2026-R-038_(RFP)_Web_Dev_4, L.7.1.3, Qualifications and Resumes of Proposed Staff and M.5.1.4, Key Personnel - Pages 51 and 56	"The Offeror shall submit a representative resumes...for each individual to assigned to perform the work required under this Solicitation." (1) Please confirm that we should provide a resume for each labor category proposed for this requirement, whether Key or not Key. (2) In addition, can the Government clarify which positions should be considered Key?	Section L.7.1.3 requires Offerors to submit a staffing plan that identifies all proposed Key Personnel positions and includes a representative resume for each specifically named Key Personnel candidate proposed to perform under the contract. Offerors are responsible for proposing the key roles they consider necessary for successful contract performance, subject to evaluation under Section M.5.1.4. Resumes are required only for proposed Key Personnel.
2	2026-R-038 (RFP) Web Dev 4.pdf, I.13 (p. 39)	Is there a requirement for websites to obtain an Authority to Operate (ATO)?	ATO is not required. However, all systems, applications, and cloud services proposed under this contract shall be subject to evaluation under the SAA CIO Cybersecurity Risk Assessment Process. The Offeror shall remediate vulnerabilities or deficiencies identified through such assessments as necessary to achieve and maintain a low or moderate risk rating, as determined by the Senate.
3	L.7.1.4 Section 4 – Past Performance	Could the government confirm Aretum meets relevant past performance requirements by submitting our Subsidiary(ies) past performance? Please note that Aretum LLC is a parent entity that intends to submit its response utilizing our fully-owned subsidiary Aretum Consulting Inc' or other subsidiaries past performance, utilizing a Meaningful Relationship between parent and subsidiaries. Aretum LLC followed the similar Meaningful Relationship Commitment Letter (MRCL) documentation to get the GSA OASIS+ Unrestricted Contract awarded under Aretum LLC (Parent Entity). Similarly, utilizing MRCL, Aretum LLC was also awarded the IDIQ Contract SeaPort NxG Contract.	Section L.7.1.4 allows references from the Offeror, including proposed subcontractors and wholly owned subsidiaries.
4	L.7.1.1.3 / M.5.1.1	Section L.7.1.1.3 states that the Offeror shall provide at least one qualifying Federal contract reference demonstrating relevant experience. Section M.5.1.3 states the Panel will review the Offeror's Subcontractors' similar experience. For the Go/No-Go Relevant Experience determination, may the qualifying Federal contract reference be held by a proposed Subcontractor, or must it be held by the Prime Offeror?	Section L.7.1.1.3 requires the Offeror to demonstrate its prior relevant Federal Government business experience as either a prime contractor or subcontractor.
5	L.7.1.4	Section L.7.1.4 requires five (5) Past Performance Questionnaires (Attachment J-006) and five (5) Past Performance Website Information forms (Attachment J-007). May the five references include a combination of Prime Contractor and Subcontractor contracts, or must all five references belong to the same entity?	Section L.7.1.4 applies to Offerors, including proposed subcontractors. The five references may include a mix of Offeror and proposed subcontractor contracts, provided the references otherwise meet the solicitation criteria and Attachment J-007 is completed for the same five references used for Attachment J-006.
6	G.5 Submission of Invoices and Payment Schedule AND G.5.4.2, 2nd paragraph	Please define "reasonable amount of time" in the statement "Payment is due within a reasonable amount of time". Does this contradict Net 60 in section G.5?	The Senate will pay within a reasonable time, defined as not later than sixty (60) calendar days after receipt of proper invoices approved by the Contracting Officer or their designee. The Senate will make reasonable efforts to process payment within thirty (30) calendar days, however, such efforts do not modify the contractual payment term of Net 60.
7	RFP Section M.5.1.4	In "Section 3 - Qualifications and Resumes of Proposed Staff," the Senate requires representative resumes, but as written the Section M - Evaluation Criteria describes scoring based on the availability and commitment of Key Personnel. Could the Senate clarify the requirement?	Section L.7.1.3 requires Offerors to submit a staffing plan that identifies all proposed Key Personnel positions and includes a representative resume for each specifically named Key Personnel candidate proposed to perform under the contract. Offerors are responsible for proposing the key roles they consider necessary for successful contract performance, subject to evaluation under Section M.5.1.4. Resumes are required only for proposed Key Personnel.
8	2026-R-038_(RFP)_Web_Dev_4, C.3.4.1 Development Requirements - Page 9	Since all development must occur within the Senate network, will sandbox, staging, and CI/CD tools be provided, or must contractors adapt to existing Senate tooling?	The SAA will provision and maintain the production CMS platform. Staging and development environments shall be governed by SAA standards and made available to awarded contractors through the Senate network.
9	Attachment J-001-A - Senate Web Development Guide Section User Data Collection AND Attachment J-001-B - Senate Web Design Guide Section User Data Collection	Please confirm whether the Contractor or SAA will be responsible for the Captcha license. It is stated in the IDIQ that the SAA will provide Adobe Analytics/Java licenses.	The SAA will be responsible for procuring required CAPTCHA licenses. The contractor shall be responsible for implementing the licensed solution as part of contract performance.
10	N/A	Is this activity considered a new requirement or a follow-on to an existing contract?	Yes. This requirement is a follow-on procurement and represents the fourth iteration of a multi-award IDIQ contract vehicle.
11	N/A	If there is an incumbent, would you be able to share the vendor's name, the contract number, value, award date and expiration date?	The SAA does not disclose information regarding incumbent contractors.
12	N/A	How are success metrics defined (traffic, engagement, task completion, accessibility)?	Website success shall be determined by the receiving Office's written acceptance of the completed project and the results of post-launch monitoring. Attachments J-001-A and J-001-B set forth applicable technical requirements, including Section 508 accessibility and security compliance. Notwithstanding those requirements, the primary performance criteria are timely, within-budget, launch-ready delivery and the Office's written acceptance.
13	N/A	Do priorities differ across Senate Offices? If so, how?	Yes. Each Senate Office functions as an independent customer and may have unique content, branding, legislative priorities, constituent service needs, and functional requirements. Member, Committee, and caucus offices may therefore require materially different website solutions. Offerors may review publicly available senate.gov websites for general comparative research regarding feature sets and presentation.

14	C. 1 IDIQ	What are typical timelines for Task Orders to be issued to making award decisions?	Task Order Proposal Requests (TOPRs) are issued on an as-needed basis under the IDIQ contract. Approved contractors will generally be provided 14 calendar days to submit a proposal in response to a TOPR. Typical procurement lead times range from approximately 3 to 5 weeks from TOPR issuance to the Office's final award decision; however, actual timelines may vary depending on the scope and complexity of the requirement. No minimum or maximum award timeframe is guaranteed.
15	J-001-A; "Approved Plugins"	What is the process for requesting new functionality or plugins?	Requests to add a new plugin to the approved list identified in Attachment J-001-A shall be submitted to the SAA for review and approval. The SAA's review process includes, at a minimum, assessments of security, accessibility, and compatibility. The review and approval process may take up to six months.
16	J-001-A; "Approved Plugins"	The document mentions that requests for additional plugins may require an additional 6 months for review and approval. Is the contractor liable for timelines going out of initial scope if this occurring during a build?	Because approval of a proposed plugin cannot be assured, contractors are expected to scope and price their proposals based on the currently approved plugin list set forth in Attachment J-001-A. Contractors shall not propose, rely upon, or otherwise include unapproved plugins in response to TOPRs. This approval process applies to plugins not currently on the approved list that a contractor may wish to use in connection with future task orders. Unless and until a plugin has been formally approved by the SAA and added to the approved list, contractors shall not reference such plugin as available for use within the proposed scope of work.
17	2026-R-038 Web Dev RFP; Pricing et al	The RFP mentions that pricing for end-user support is included in the scope of this engagement. Can you please clarify if "end-user" in this context is internal team members or audience members that are visiting the senate.gov sites?	For purposes of this RFP, "end-user support" means support provided to Senate Office personnel who use the SAA-provided CMS to create, update, and maintain content for their Office's website.
18	J-001-B; "Future updates"	How frequently are the design guides updated? Do all sites share a common theme or components?	There is no established or fixed schedule for updates to these documents. Updates are issued infrequently, however, contractors are responsible for reviewing all current solicitation materials, including any revisions to these documents, prior to submitting a proposal in response to each TOPR. Offerors should refer to Attachments J-001-A and J-001-B for information regarding components and requirements that are generally common to newly established Office websites.
19	J-001-B; "Design and Functionality"	Do the offices share the same color palette, typography, fonts, etc.?	No. Each Senate Office independently determines its branding and visual design preferences, including but not limited to color palette, typography, font selection, layout, and other design elements.
20	J-003; Content Migration	Can the SAA provide guidance on the typical scale and complexity of content migration (e.g., number of pages, document types, integrations)?	The scope, scale, and complexity of website migrations may vary substantially depending on multiple factors, including the type of Office involved (for example, Member, Committee, or caucus), the age and maturity of the Office's existing web presence, and, in the case of a redesign, the content management system currently supporting the existing website.
21	J-001 A/B	Are there standardized content models, taxonomies, or governance practices that contractors should follow across Senate Office websites?	Senate Offices are not required to adhere to a uniform or standardized content model, taxonomy, navigation structure, or information architecture. Mandatory cross-site requirements are generally limited to applicable accessibility standards, including Section 508, ADA Title II, and the latest applicable WCAG requirements pursuant to C.3.4.9; security requirements, including Attachment J-005 Cybersecurity SOPs and C.3.4.1; privacy and user data handling requirements, including those set forth in Attachments J-001-A and J-001-B; use of approved plugins and approved social media platforms as identified in the applicable attachments; and the SAA-provided WordPress base build. Subject to those requirements, each Office retains discretion over its content structure, taxonomy, navigation approach, and editorial governance.
22	J-001-A; CMS Base builds	Are development, staging, and production environments provisioned by the SAA, and what are the deployment expectations?	In accordance with Attachment J-001-A, the SAA shall provision the CMS platform and the supporting infrastructure.
23	N/A	Is remote work permitted for this engagement, or are there any on-site requirements for contractors?	Remote performance is permitted and anticipated under this requirement. There are no on-site performance requirements.
24	N/A	Is there any preference or evaluation advantage for SDVOSB or other small business categories under this contract?	No. As set forth in Section M of the Solicitation, award will be made using a best-value tradeoff source selection methodology.
25	M.5.1.1 / L.7.1.1.3	The Go/No-Go Relevant Experience factor (M.5.1.1) requires the Offeror to demonstrate relevant business with the federal government, and Section L.7.1.1.3 requires at least one qualifying Federal contract reference. (a) Does experience as a subcontractor on a Federal prime contract satisfy this requirement? (b) May an Offeror reference Federal contract experience gained by its key personnel while employed at a prior firm? (c) Does state or local government contract experience qualify under this factor?	(a) Yes. Relevant work performed by the Offeror entity as a subcontractor under a Federal prime contract may be submitted to satisfy the requirements of M.5.1.1. (b) No. The Go/No-Go Relevant Experience factor evaluates the Offeror entity's organizational contract experience, not the experience of individual personnel. (c) No. Section M.5.1.1 expressly requires relevant business performed with the Federal Government. State and local government experience does not satisfy this requirement, but may be submitted for consideration under Factor 2, Past Performance.
26	C.3.11.2 / Attachment J-001-A	What Content Management System(s) does the SAA currently provide to Senate Offices as its standard base build? For example, is Drupal the primary CMS, and if so, which version(s) are in active use? This will help offerors accurately represent their CMS expertise in their technical proposals.	The SAA provides a WordPress base build for all newly elected Senators. The base build will utilize the version of WordPress that is current at the time the base build is created.
27	C.1.3	Section C.1.3 states contractors must use SAA-provided resources and Senate-supplied equipment when connecting to Senate systems. Is all development work required to be performed exclusively on Senate-provided hardware, or may contractors use their own equipment (e.g., personal or company-owned laptops with VPN access) for development and testing prior to deploying to the Senate network?	All development activities shall be performed using Senate-furnished equipment on the Senate network. Development work performed on non-Senate devices may not be transferred, ported, or otherwise migrated into the Senate environment.

28	General / H (Security)	Does performance of this contract require personnel to hold any security clearance or pass a Senate background investigation? If so, what level of investigation is required, and is there a timeline by which clearances must be obtained after contract award?	Any contractor personnel requiring access to the Senate network must successfully complete the applicable background investigation process before VPN credentials will be issued. In accordance with Section H.4.3.2, personnel security processing requires a minimum lead time of two weeks.
29	General / C.3	Is remote work authorized for day-to-day contract performance (e.g., website design, development, and maintenance tasks), or is regular on-site presence at Senate facilities in Washington, DC required? If both, please clarify which tasks require on-site presence.	Remote performance is permitted and anticipated under this requirement. There are no on-site performance requirements.
30	L.7.1.4 / Attachment J-006	For the five (5) Past Performance Questionnaires (Attachment J-006): must completed questionnaires be received at acquisitions@saa.senate.gov by the May 4, 2026 proposal deadline, or may they be submitted by references directly to the SAA either before or shortly after the proposal deadline?	Past Performance Questionnaires (Attachment J-006) must be submitted directly by the reference point of contact to acquisitions@saa.senate.gov no later than the proposal due date.
31	C.3.1.8.d / L.7.1.1.3	Section C.3.1.8.d requires 'references and examples of the Contractor's website graphic design work previously completed and available to view in a web browser.' Are commercial or private-sector website portfolio examples acceptable, or must all referenced work involve federal, state, or local government websites?	Commercial and private-sector website portfolio examples are acceptable, provided that each example is publicly accessible via a web browser and demonstrates capabilities relevant to the graphic design requirements of this solicitation.
32	L.7.2.2.1.d / Section K	Will the SAA provide a fillable Section K (Representations and Certifications) template as part of this solicitation, or should offerors submit their current SAM.gov representations and certifications (online reps and certs) to satisfy this requirement?	The Offeror shall complete the fillable Section K for the prime contractor and for each proposed subcontractor, if any, and shall include the completed forms within the model contract submission.
33	L.7.2.2.1.a / Section A	For the completed Section A (solicitation/contract form, page 1, subsections 9–14) required in Volume II: is an electronic or digital signature (e.g., DocuSign, PDF signature) acceptable, or is a handwritten wet signature required prior to scanning and submission?	Electronic or digital signatures, including DocuSign and PDF-applied signatures, are acceptable for Section A and all other signature blocks included in the proposal, provided that the signature clearly identifies the authorized representative by name and title and is affixed by an individual authorized to bind the Offeror.
34	L.3	For proposals requiring multiple email transmissions due to the 6MB size limit, what subject line convention should be used? For example: '2026-R-038 Skilak Consulting — Transmission 1 of 3' and '2026-R-038 Skilak Consulting — Final Transmission (3 of 3)'? Please confirm the preferred format.	The SAA does not prescribe a required subject-line format for proposals submitted in multiple transmissions pursuant to Section L.3. Any clear and consistently applied subject-line convention is acceptable.
35	H.3 / M.5.1.4	Section M.5.1.4 references Key Personnel requirements defined in Section H.3. Please confirm the specific Key Personnel position titles and minimum qualifications required, as this information is critical to the staffing plan in our technical proposal.	The solicitation does not identify specific Key Personnel labor categories, position titles, or minimum qualification requirements. Offerors are responsible for identifying proposed Key Personnel and demonstrating that such personnel possess qualifications appropriate to the requirements of the statement of work. Key Personnel will be evaluated in accordance with the criteria set forth in Section M.5.1.4.
36	C.3.4.1.4 / Attachment J-005	Section C.3.4.1.4 requires contractors to follow OWASP Top 10 coding practices. Should offerors reference the most current version of the OWASP Top 10 (2021), or is a specific version mandated? Additionally, does the Senate have a preferred vulnerability scanning or SAST tool for OWASP compliance verification?	Offerors shall align with the most current version of the OWASP Top 10 in effect as of the proposal due date. The SAA does not require the use of any specific vulnerability scanning tool or static application security testing (SAST) tool for purposes of demonstrating OWASP compliance.
37	B.7.1 / L.7.2.1	For the pricing proposal, should labor rates in Section B.7.1 reflect fully burdened all-inclusive rates (inclusive of overhead, G&A, fringe, and profit), or should cost elements be broken out separately? Please confirm the preferred format for the pricing narrative/rationale.	Rates proposed in Section B.7.1 shall be fully burdened and all-inclusive. The CLIN table shall include one rate per CLIN for each applicable period: hourly rates for labor-hour CLINs and monthly rates for firm-fixed-price support CLINs. If subcontractors are proposed, the rates entered in the CLIN table shall reflect composite prices or rates. The supporting pricing narrative shall describe the services included, applicable assumptions, exceptions or dependencies, and the basis for the proposed pricing. Offerors may provide additional labor category detail in the narrative to support price reasonableness.
38	2026-R-038_(RFP)_Web_Dev_4, C.3.1 C.3 Statement of Work - Page 6	Can the Government provide a list of Senate Offices that may participate in this IDIQ?	All Member offices, Committee offices, and other eligible Senate offices, including non-Member offices, may obtain public-facing websites under this contract.
39	Attachment J-001-A Senate Web Development Guide, CMS Base Builds - Page 4	Can the Government clarify whether the SAA-provided WordPress environment is implemented as a multisite architecture, and if so, how governance is managed across sites (e.g., shared themes, plugin controls, deployment processes, and site-level customization boundaries)?	A multisite architecture will not be implemented under this contract.
40	2026-R-038_(RFP)_Web_Dev_4, B.8 Contract Ceiling and Guaranteed Minimum - Page 5	Given that there is no guaranteed minimum and multiple IDIQ awards are anticipated, can the Government provide an estimated number of Task Orders per year or historical ordering patterns to help vendors plan staffing and pricing strategies?	The volume of task orders may fluctuate significantly based on election outcomes. Task Order Proposal Requests (TOPRs) are issued for all newly sworn-in Senators and for any Senate office, including Member, Committee, caucus, and other eligible offices, that requests a redesign or redevelopment of its existing website.
41	2026-R-038_(RFP)_Web_Dev_4, C.3.1 Pre-Award Procedures - Page 6	Will Task Order evaluations be based solely on Office preference, or will the SAA apply standardized evaluation criteria across TOPRs (e.g., technical, past performance, price)?	Task order awards are made based on the preferences and requirements of the requesting Office. However, the SAA reserves the right to exclude from consideration any proposal that does not conform to contract requirements.
42	2026-R-038_(RFP)_Web_Dev_4, C.3.1.7 Task Order Proposal Requirements - Page 7	Is the 20-page limit for TOPR responses inclusive of resumes, past performance, and visuals, or are any sections excluded from the page count?	In accordance with Section L.6, resumes, references, past performance information, certifications, and attachments shall not count toward the Technical Proposal page limitation.
43	2026-R-038_(RFP)_Web_Dev_4, B.3 Contract Type - Page 2	For Labor-Hour Task Orders, will the Government provide estimated level-of-effort ranges in TOPRs, or is scoping entirely the responsibility of the Contractor?	Project scoping is the responsibility of the contractor and shall be based on the Office requirements identified in the applicable TOPR.

44	2026-R-038_(RFP)_Web_Dev_4, B.4 Pricing - Page 2	Are there expectations or guidance regarding the proportion of work anticipated under Firm-Fixed-Price vs. Labor-Hour Task Orders?	The SAA is unable to provide such figures, as requirements vary considerably by Office and may fluctuate substantially based on election outcomes and other operational factors.
45	Attachment J-001-A Senate Web Development Guide, CMS Base Builds - Page 4	Given that WordPress is the provided CMS base build, are contractors permitted to propose alternative CMS platforms under any circumstances or is WordPress strictly required?	The Senate is not considering alternative CMS platforms under this solicitation.
46	Attachment J-001-A Senate Web Development Guide, Custom Code - Page 5	What is the typical approval timeline for custom code requests, and how should contractors account for this in project schedules?	Use of custom code is uncommon, and approval timelines vary depending on the business need, scope, security considerations, and staff availability. Accordingly, Offerors should scope TOPR responses based on the approved plugin list and the SAA-provided WordPress base build and should not propose schedules that are dependent upon pending approval of custom code.
47	Attachment J-001-A Senate Web Development Guide, Plugins - Page 4–5	Can the Government clarify the process and expected timeline for approving new plugins, especially for functionality not currently supported by the approved list?	In accordance with Attachment J-001-A, proposed plugins are subject to SAA review for security, accessibility, and compatibility. The review and approval process may require up to six (6) months.
48	Attachment J-002 Website Testing and QA Requirements - Page 3–5	Are there standardized templates or reporting formats required for defect tracking, readiness reviews, and testing documentation?	The Solicitation does not prescribe standard report formats. However, all reports delivered under the contract shall comply with all applicable contractual requirements.
49	2026-R-038_(RFP)_Web_Dev_4, C.3.5 QA Requirements - Page 10	Will the Government provide access to automated testing tools or environments, or are contractors expected to supply their own testing frameworks within Senate constraints?	The SAA provides an accessibility testing tool, as referenced in Attachment J-002, as well as the staging and production deployment pipeline.
50	2026-R-038_(RFP)_Web_Dev_4, C.3.4.7 Search Requirements - Page 10	Is there an existing enterprise search solution (e.g., indexing service) that contractors must integrate with, or are search implementations expected to be handled within the CMS?	Search functionality is expected to be implemented through the CMS. In addition, certain approved plugins may be used to provide enhanced search capabilities, as identified in Attachment J-001-A, Approved Plugins.
51	2026-R-038_(RFP)_Web_Dev_4, C.3.4.8 CDN Compatibility - Page 10	Can the Government specify the current Content Delivery Network (CDN) and any performance or caching requirements contractors must design against?	The Senate utilizes Akamai as its content delivery network (CDN). Specific security-related requirements and constraints associated with Akamai are set forth in Attachment J-001-A, User Data Collection.
52	2026-R-038_(RFP)_Web_Dev_4, C.3.6 Website Maintenance - Page 11	Are there defined SLAs for issue resolution beyond the 15-minute acknowledgement requirement, such as response and resolution time tiers?	The contract does not establish specific service-level agreements (SLAs) for issue resolution. Nevertheless, Offerors should recognize that Senate Offices expect timely resolution and proactive status communication commensurate with the severity and urgency of the service request.
53	2026-R-038_(RFP)_Web_Dev_4, C.3.8 Defect Remediation - Page 12	Can the Government clarify expectations for “no-cost” defect remediation over time (e.g., duration, scope boundaries, and distinction from new feature requests)?	For purposes of contract performance, defects are issues involving features, functionality, or content that have already been developed and implemented on an Office website but are subsequently found not to function as intended. By contrast, new feature requests involve the development or addition of new functionality, features, or content not previously implemented.
54	Attachment J-003 Sample TOPR - Page 1–2	Will all TOPRs follow a similar structure and level of detail as the sample, or should contractors expect significant variability in requirements and documentation?	TOPRs will generally follow a structure similar to the sample provided; however, the specific requirements, as well as the level of detail and supporting documentation, may vary by Office and by individual TOPR.
55	Attachment J-003 Sample TOPR, Content Migration - Page 2	For non-WordPress sites requiring migration, will the Government provide inventories, data schemas, or migration tools, or is full discovery expected from the Contractor?	For migrations from non-WordPress websites, the Senate will provide available content databases and will make available any approved plugins that facilitate migration to WordPress. The awarded contractor is expected to derive as much schema-related knowledge as reasonably possible from initial migrations and to retain and apply that knowledge in support of future migration efforts.
56	Attachment J-004 Senate Supported Software List - Page 1	Are there any restrictions on development tools (e.g., IDEs, build tools, version control systems) beyond the supported software list that contractors should plan for?	Contractors shall use only tools identified on the Senate Supported Software List set forth in Attachment J-004 for any activity involving Senate systems.
57	2026-R-038_(RFP)_Web_Dev_4, Section M Evaluation Factors - Page 53–57	Can the Government clarify the relative weighting of technical approach, past performance, and price for base IDIQ awards?	As provided in Section M, the Technical Approach factor is more important than Past Performance, and when combined, all technical evaluation factors are more important than Price. Offerors should refer to Section M of the Solicitation for the complete relative weighting of all evaluation factors.
58	2026-R-038_(RFP)_Web_Dev_4, C.3.1.8 Non-TOPR Documentation - Page 7	Will the non-TOPR documentation (e.g., design approach, staffing, past work) be evaluated as part of the base IDIQ award, or only used during TOPR competitions?	Any and all information submitted by Offerors as part of their contract proposals may be used by the SAA for purposes of proposal evaluation in accordance with the terms of the Solicitation.
59	2026-R-038_(RFP)_Web_Dev_4, C.3.3 Task Order Administration - Page 8	Can the Government clarify the expected level of direct interaction between contractors and Senate Office staff versus coordination through the COR?	Routine day-to-day coordination with Senate Office staff is expected and is a normal aspect of contract performance. Coordination with the Contracting Officer’s Representative (COR) is required for contract administration matters, including, but not limited to, invoicing, contract modifications, task order issuance, and acceptance.
60	2026-R-038_(RFP)_Web_Dev_4, C.3.4 Accessibility Requirements - Page 10	Which WCAG version will be enforced at delivery (e.g., 2.1 AA vs. 2.2), and will this vary over the life of the contract?	In accordance with Section C.3.4.9, the required accessibility delivery standard is WCAG 2.2 Level AA.
61	Attachment J-001-A Senate Web Development Guide, CMS Base Builds - Page 7	Can the Government specify if there are any customizations to the Adobe Analytics implementation that should be maintained?	No specific customizations are required to be maintained unless such requirement is expressly identified in the applicable TOPR.
62	2026-R-038_(RFP)_Web_Dev_4, L.7.1.1.3, Offeror Relevant Experience - Page 50	The offeror is instructed to provide at least one qualifying contract reference of a recently awarded, relevant project that has been awarded within the past 3 years AND were designed using the targeted CMS. Will the Government please define “targeted CMS?”	The target content management system under this Solicitation is WordPress.
63	General	Are there incumbent vendors currently providing these services to SSA? If yes, please provide vendor names and contract numbers.	This procurement is being conducted under a multi-award IDIQ contract structure in which multiple incumbent contractors compete for TOPRs. The SAA does not disclose incumbent contractor names, contract numbers, or contract values.

64	2026-R-038_(RFP)_Web_Dev_4, L.7.1.1.3 and M.5.1.3 Conflict - Page 55	Section L.7.1.1.3 refers to project examples AWARDED within the past 3 years whereas M.5.1.3 refers to project that are CURRENTLY ONGOING or COMPLETED within the past 3 years. Please clarify the time window for projects suitable to use as references.	The two time-based requirements apply independently. Section L.7.1.1.3 governs eligibility for the Offeror Relevant Experience requirement and requires that the referenced work have been awarded within the past three (3) years. Section M.5.1.3 governs the relevance standard for Past Performance evaluation and requires that the referenced work be ongoing or completed within the past three (3) years. References submitted by the Offeror must satisfy the applicable timeframe requirement for the evaluation factor under which they are provided.
65	2026-R-038_(RFP)_Web_Dev_4, L.7.1.4, Past Performance - Page 52	The Offeror is instructed to send a Past Performance Questionnaire (PPQ) to 5 relevant references. If the contract being used as a reference has a CPARs, can we use that in lieu of a PPQ?	CPARS information may be cited within the technical proposal as supplemental past performance information, however, CPARS does not replace the Past Performance Questionnaire (Attachment J-006) required by Section L.7.1.4.
66	2026-R-038_(RFP)_Web_Dev_4, L.7.1.4, Past Performance - Page 52	Please confirm that if we are proposing use of a Subcontractor, we can use their past performance as 1 or 2 of the 5 to be submitted.	Confirmed.
67	2026-R-038_(RFP)_Web_Dev_4, L.7.2.1, Price Section Instructions - Page 53	Please confirm that we should use the table format presented in B.7.1 to prepare our price proposal.	Confirmed.
68	2026-R-038_(RFP)_Web_Dev_4, L.7.2.1, Price Section Instructions - Page 53	The offeror is instructed to "provide the firm-fixed-rates for all the services, material, and deliverables inclusive of approved fully burdened direct labor rates, travel, per diem, and other direct costs." We understand the labor rate guidance but without specifics of travel, per diem, and ODCs, how are we to approach firm-fixed-rates for non-labor costs?	Offerors should propose fully burdened labor rates in Section B.7.1 that, to the extent practicable, include all anticipated travel costs, per diem, and other direct costs (ODCs).
69	Attachment J-003 - _Sample_Task_Order_Proposal_Request_(TOPR)	Please confirm that the Sample TOPR is provided for informational purposes only and does not require a proposal response with our May 4 submission.	Confirmed.
70	2026-R-038 (RFP) Web Dev 4.pdf, C.3.1.7.1 (p. 7); L.6-L.7 (pp. 49-53)	Please confirm that the twenty (20) page limit in Section C.3.1.7.1 applies only to post-award Task Order Proposal Requests (TOPRs), and that the current IDIQ proposal should follow the page limits and volume structure in Section L.	Confirmed.
71	2026-R-038 (RFP) Web Dev 4.pdf, B.1 (p. 2)	Is the scope of this contract a single site or website for all of the US Senate office?	This IDIQ contract is intended to support the development and maintenance of individual public-facing websites for Senate Offices, including Member, Committee, and other eligible Offices. It does not contemplate a single, unified enterprise platform. Each task order will pertain to the website requirements of a single Office.
72	2026-R-038 (RFP) Web Dev 4.pdf, B.7.1 (pp. 3-4)	What is estimated level of effort by CLIN per year?	No. Task order volume may vary based on election outcomes, and the level of effort for each task order will depend on the specific requirements of the requesting Office.
73	2026-R-038 (RFP) Web Dev 4.pdf, C.3.4.1.1 (p. 9)	Are there different environments on the Senate network, e.g., Dev, Test, Prod?	Yes. The SAA shall provision the applicable environments, and detailed information regarding those environments will be provided to awarded contractors.
74	2026-R-038 (RFP) Web Dev 4.pdf, C.3.4.2 (p. 9)	Does the sample TOPR need to be addressed in the proposal?	No.
75	2026-R-038 (RFP) Web Dev 4.pdf, H.3 (p. 24)	What roles are key?	The Solicitation does not prescribe specific Key Personnel labor categories or position titles. Offerors are responsible for identifying and designating proposed Key Personnel, which will be evaluated in accordance with Section M.5.1.4.
76	General Comment	Is there an incumbent contractor?	Yes. This requirement is being procured under a multi-award IDIQ contract structure, with multiple incumbent contractors eligible to compete for TOPRs.
77	General Comment	How many awards does SAA expect to make?	Awards will be made to all Offerors determined to be eligible for award under the best-value tradeoff methodology set forth in Section M of the Solicitation.
78	General Comment	Where are the web sites currently hosted?	The SAA shall provide the production hosting environment for Senate Office websites within the SAA-managed Senate environment. Detailed technical information regarding that environment will be provided to awarded contractors.
79	Attachment J-005 - U.S. Sergeant at Arms Standard Operating Procedures (SOPS) for Cybersecurity.pdf, §14.2-14.3 (pp. 30-32); 2026-R-038 (RFP) Web Dev 4.pdf, L.7.1 (pp. 49-53)	Attachment J-005 states that the Contractor will provide a comprehensive Contractor Cybersecurity Plan (CSP) in its proposal. Please confirm whether a standalone CSP is required in the current IDIQ proposal submission, and if so, identify the required volume/section and whether it counts toward the Technical Volume page limit.	Confirmed.
80	Attachment J-001-A - Senate Web Development Guide.pdf, 'Compliance and Future Updates' (p. 3); Attachment J-001-B - Senate Web Design Guide.pdf, 'Future Updates' (p. 3); 2026-R-038 (RFP) Web Dev 4.pdf, C.3.4.5 (p. 10)	The guides state that requirements may be revised and that awarded contractors must rely on an internal SAA site. For purposes of this solicitation, please confirm that offerors will be evaluated only against the versions of the attachments issued with the solicitation (plus any formal amendments), and not against unpublished or future internal guidance.	Confirmed.
81	2026-R-038 (RFP) Web Dev 4.pdf, C.3.11.2 (p. 14); Attachment J-001-A - Senate Web Development Guide.pdf, 'Content Management System Base Builds' (p. 4); Attachment J-001-B - Senate Web Design Guide.pdf, 'General Guidelines' (p. 4); Attachment J-003 - Sample Task Order Proposal Request (TOPR).pdf, 'Content Migration' (p. 2)	Please confirm whether WordPress is the only approved CMS for performance under this IDIQ, and whether references in the sample TOPR to a contractor's 'proposed CMS' should be understood as WordPress within the SAA-provided environment rather than an offeror-selected alternative CMS.	Confirmed.

82	Attachment J-001-A - Senate Web Development Guide.pdf, 'Approved CMS Plugins' and 'Custom Code' (pp. 4-5); Attachment J-001-B - Senate Web Design Guide.pdf, 'Approved CMS Plugins and Design Functionality' (p. 4)	If a required feature cannot be provided through the current approved plugin set and requires either a new plugin review or approved custom code, should offerors assume that such functionality may be proposed conditionally, or should it be excluded from scope until SAA approval is obtained?	In responding to Task Order Proposal Requests (TOPRs), contractors should identify any instances in which the current list of approved plugins does not satisfy the functional requirements of the effort. In such cases, the contractor should specify what additional plugin, if any, would need to be added to the approved plugin list and/or, in the limited circumstances where necessary, indicate that custom code would be required to meet the stated requirement.
83	Attachment J-003 - Sample Task Order Proposal Request (TOPR).pdf, 'Approved social media feeds' and 'share website content on social media' (pp. 3-4); Attachment J-001-A - Senate Web Development Guide.pdf, 'Social Media Integration / Privacy Concerns' (pp. 7-8); Attachment J-001-B - Senate Web Design Guide.pdf, 'Privacy Concerns' (pp. 6-7)	Please clarify the compliant implementation methods for 'approved social media feeds' and social sharing functionality, given the prohibition on embedding third-party code, widgets, JavaScript, API calls, and external iFrames. For example, are simple outbound links or static/manual content displays the intended approach?	This prohibition applies to unapproved third-party integrations. Third-party integrations that have been expressly approved by the Senate, including approved social media platforms, are permitted.
84	Attachment J-001-A - Senate Web Development Guide.pdf, 'Approved social media platforms' (pp. 7-8); Attachment J-001-B - Senate Web Design Guide.pdf, 'Approved social media platforms' (pp. 6-7)	Please confirm whether the approved social media platform list in Attachments J-001-A and J-001-B is the complete list for proposal and performance purposes unless the SAA issues a written exception, and whether any changes to the list prior to award will be issued by formal amendment.	Confirmed.
85	2026-R-038 (RFP) Web Dev 4.pdf, C.3.4.9 (p. 10); Attachment J-001-B - Senate Web Design Guide.pdf, 'Accessibility' (p. 8); Attachment J-003 - Sample Task Order Proposal Request (TOPR).pdf, 'Accessibility' (p. 2)	Section C.3.4.9 references Section 508, ADA Title II, and 'the latest WCAG standard applicable at delivery.' Please identify the specific WCAG version and conformance level that offerors should propose against (e.g., WCAG 2.1 AA, WCAG 2.2 AA, or other).	In accordance with Section C.3.4.9, the required accessibility delivery standard is WCAG 2.2 Level AA.
86	2026-R-038 (RFP) Web Dev 4.pdf, C.3.5 (p. 10); Attachment J-002 - Website Testing and Quality Assurance Requirements.pdf, pp. 3-7	Attachment J-002 references a Senate-provided accessibility test tool and an internal SAA knowledgebase site for additional testing guidance. Will the SAA identify the specific required tools and any mandatory internal procedures for offerors during the solicitation period, or are those details only provided after award?	Information regarding Senate-provided accessibility testing tools and applicable internal knowledgebase procedures will be communicated to awarded contractors after contract award.
87	2026-R-038 (RFP) Web Dev 4.pdf, C.1.3 (p. 5); F.2.2-F.3 (pp. 19-20); Attachment J-005 - U.S. Sergeant at Arms Standard Operating Procedures (SOPS) for Cybersecurity.pdf, §14.2-14.3 (pp. 30-32)	Please clarify whether any contractor-owned systems may ever directly connect to Senate systems, networks, or VPNs under this contract, or whether all such access must occur exclusively through Senate-provided equipment. If contractor corporate IT assets are never permitted to connect directly, please confirm that references to those assets in the CSP requirements are limited to the contractor's internal development/support environment.	Pursuant to Sections F.2.2 and F.3, all access to the Senate network must occur through Senate-Furnished Equipment (SFE). Accordingly, references in Attachment J-005 to contractor corporate IT assets pertain to the contractor's internal development and support environment, rather than to direct access to Senate systems.
88	Attachment J-005 - U.S. Sergeant at Arms Standard Operating Procedures (SOPS) for Cybersecurity.pdf, §14.3.8 and §15 (pp. 35, 50); 2026-R-038 (RFP) Web Dev 4.pdf, C.3.6 (pp. 11-12)	Please clarify the authorization model for remote support. Is written authorization required only for CPS/CSS server access, while oral or ticket-based approval is sufficient for other office systems on an as-needed basis, or is written authorization required for all categories of remote access?	Remote access to Office websites and/or associated data shall be granted only upon issuance of a task order, receipt of a specific service request from an Office or the SAA, or as otherwise expressly authorized by the SAA.
89	2026-R-038 (RFP) Web Dev 4.pdf, H.4.3 (pp. 25-27); L.7.1 (pp. 49-53)	Please confirm whether background checks, non-disclosure forms, and related personnel security documents are post-award onboarding requirements only, or whether any of these materials must be submitted with the current proposal for proposed key personnel or other staff.	Background investigations, non-disclosure agreements, and related personnel security documentation are post-award requirements only.
90	2026-R-038 (RFP) Web Dev 4.pdf, H.4.3.1-H.4.3.3 (pp. 26-27); F.2-F.3 (pp. 19-20)	Please confirm whether the U.S. citizenship/eligibility and background check requirements apply only to personnel who require Senate building access, Senate-issued devices, or Senate network/system access, or whether they apply to all contractor and subcontractor personnel supporting the contract, including personnel performing offsite work with no direct Senate access.	U.S. citizenship or other applicable work eligibility requirements, as well as background investigation requirements, apply to all contractor personnel who will perform work under this contract.
91	2026-R-038 (RFP) Web Dev 4.pdf, F.2-F.2.1 (p. 19)	Section F.2.1 states that contractor sites, including home offices, may be audited. Please clarify whether this requirement applies to any home office used for any level of contract support, including proposal support, project management, and content-only support, or only to locations that access Senate systems/data.	Confirmed. This requirement applies to any and all contractor facilities or sites involved in performance under the contract.
92	2026-R-038 (RFP) Web Dev 4.pdf, C.3.6.3 (p. 11)	Please clarify the scope of the requirement for a human acknowledgement of any service request within fifteen (15) minutes during normal business hours. Does this apply to all request channels (email, phone, ticketing portal), and is it measured from initial receipt by the contractor or from routing to the responsible support team?	This requirement applies to all communication channels and shall be measured from the contractor's initial receipt of a communication from an Office.
93	2026-R-038 (RFP) Web Dev 4.pdf, C.3.8 and E.1.4 (pp. 12, 17-18); Attachment J-002 - Website Testing and Quality Assurance Requirements.pdf, 'Website Exception Period' (p. 7)	Please clarify whether the obligation to repair defects at no additional cost 'regardless of when identified' is limited to contractor-caused defects as defined in Section E.1.4, and does not extend to failures caused solely by SAA-managed platform changes, SAA plugin/core updates, approved third-party service changes, or office content changes.	Confirmed.
94	2026-R-038 (RFP) Web Dev 4.pdf, E.1.7 and H.16 (pp. 17, 31-32); Attachment J-003 - Sample Task Order Proposal Request (TOPR).pdf, 'Statement of Work' (p. 1)	Please clarify the distinction between the eight (8) hours of Post-Launch Emergency Support referenced in the sample TOPR and the separate emergency support provisions in Section H.16. Are Senate-declared emergency/crisis support requirements outside the included eight hours separately compensable under H.16?	Neither Senate declared nor Office declared emergencies are excluded from the scope of this provision. All work performed under this contract, including end-user support, requires an explicit task order. This provision is intended to ensure that Offices that elect not to include end-user support in their initial task order for website design and development may nevertheless obtain a limited amount of urgent support, up to a maximum of eight (8) hours, from the contractor that developed the site, without requiring the Office to wait for issuance of a separate task order for ongoing support beyond that initial period.

95	Attachment J-003 - Sample Task Order Proposal Request (TOPR).pdf, 'Content Migration' (p. 2); 2026-R-038 (RFP) Web Dev 4.pdf, B.7.1 and C.3 (pp. 3, 6)	The sample TOPR states that content migration is not required for websites currently in WordPress, while the IDIQ includes a separate Content Migration CLIN. Please confirm whether offerors should assume that WordPress-to-WordPress rebuilds generally exclude content migration unless a TOPR expressly requires it.	Confirmed.
96	2026-R-038 (RFP) Web Dev 4.pdf, C.3.6.5 (p. 11); Attachment J-001-A - Senate Web Development Guide.pdf, 'Website Analytics' and 'Social Media Integration' (pp. 7-8)	Please identify the Senate-provided tools, if any, that contractors are expected to use for search engine optimization, analytics support, and accessibility support during ongoing Website Maintenance and End-user Support, or confirm that this information will be provided only after award.	Attachment J-001-A identifies the Adobe Analytics baseline and the approved plugin set, including approved SEO support plugins. Attachment J-002 references the Senate provided accessibility testing tool. Additional implementation details will be provided to the awarded contractor after award.
97	2026-R-038 (RFP) Web Dev 4.pdf, C.3 (p. 6); Attachment J-001-A - Senate Web Development Guide.pdf, 'User Data Collection' and 'Capture of External IP Addresses' (pp. 5-6); Attachment J-001-B - Senate Web Design Guide.pdf, 'User Data Collection' (p. 6)	Please clarify whether any temporary server-side processing, queuing, anti-spam filtering, or transient logging of form submissions is permitted so long as the data is transmitted only to the approved office recipient or CSS and is not stored for user-facing retrieval. If so, please describe any permissible constraints.	Temporary server-side processing, anti-spam filtering, and transient logging of non-PII data are permissible provided that: (a) the data is transmitted only to the approved Office recipient or CSS; (b) no user-facing capability is provided to retrieve stored data; and (c) all such processing complies with Attachment J-005.
98	Attachment J-001-A - Senate Web Development Guide.pdf, 'Capture of External IP Addresses' (p. 5); 2026-R-038 (RFP) Web Dev 4.pdf, C.3.4.1.2 (p. 9)	Because Attachment J-001-A states that SAA will add the Akamai True-Client IP code to the base WordPress templates, please confirm whether contractors are nevertheless responsible for validating external IP capture on every form and every approved form plugin/module used on the site prior to launch.	Confirmed.
99	2026-R-038 (RFP) Web Dev 4.pdf, H.13-H.14 (pp. 30-31); Attachment J-001-A - Senate Web Development Guide.pdf, 'Custom Code' (p. 5)	Please clarify the ownership treatment of pre-existing contractor accelerators, templates, and reusable components that may be incorporated into child themes or other approved custom code. Specifically, does Section H.13 require assignment of all such incorporated materials, or may pre-existing contractor intellectual property remain contractor-owned subject to a license to the Senate?	Pursuant to Section H.13, the Contractor grants the SAA a non-exclusive, perpetual, non-transferable, royalty-free license to use any ideas, know-how, or techniques developed, used, or provided in performance of the Statement of Work, including any enhancements to the Contractor's software source code or related documentation. In addition, intellectual property rights shall convey to the SAA upon full payment for all products and data delivered under the contract. Accordingly, any custom code, templates, or other reusable components must receive prior SAA approval before being proposed in response to a TOPR, must provide the Senate with a perpetual and unrestricted license for use, and must be portable and freely transferable to any successor awarded contractor in the event the incumbent contractor is not selected for a subsequent re-compete of the applicable website.
100	2026-R-038 (RFP) Web Dev 4.pdf, L.7.1.4 (pp. 52-53); Attachment J-006 - Past Performance Questionnaire.pdf (p. 1); Attachment J-007 - Past Performance - Website Information.pdf (pp. 1-6)	Section L.7.1.4 provides special instructions for current Senate website development providers. Please clarify whether former Senate providers, proposed subcontractors, or team members with prior Senate website experience may use Senate-related references other than the current COR, and whether member office references are permissible for those entities.	Confirmed.
101	2026-R-038 (RFP) Web Dev 4.pdf, G.2-G.3 (pp. 21-22); C.3.3-C.4 (pp. 8-16); Attachment J-001-B - Senate Web Design Guide.pdf, 'Design Mockups' (p. 5); Attachment J-002 - Website Testing and Quality Assurance Requirements.pdf, pp. 4-7	Please clarify the intended approval authority among the Contracting Officer, COR, and Office POC for key project milestones. In particular, which party controls: (1) scope changes, (2) design approval, (3) test/readiness approval, (4) launch approval, and (5) final website acceptance?	The applicable approval authorities are as follows: (1) Scope changes: the Office point of contact (POC), the Contracting Officer, and the COR, as applicable through formal contract modification; (2) Design approval: the Office POC, subject to SAA review for compliance with applicable design standards; (3) Testing / readiness approval: the Office POC, subject to SAA Technical Quality Assurance (TQA) compliance requirements set forth in Attachment J-002; (4) Launch approval: the Office POC; and (5) Final acceptance: the Office POC's written acceptance.
102	2026-R-038 (RFP) Web Dev 4.pdf; Attachment J-003 - Sample Task Order Proposal Request; Item 3 Content Migration (p. 2)	What Content Management Systems are being used other than WordPress? How many sites exist for each Non-wordPress CMS?	The SAA does not maintain or publish an inventory of non-WordPress CMS deployments.
103	2026-R-038 (RFP) Web Dev 4.pdf; B.4, (p. 2)	How should monthly rates be calculated?	Monthly rates applicable to ongoing maintenance and end-user support CLINs shall be calculated based on the projected monthly level of effort multiplied by the fully burdened fixed rate for the applicable labor category and proposed as a firm-fixed monthly amount in accordance with Section B.7.1. Offerors should describe in their pricing narrative the level of service to be provided under the proposed monthly support program, including any assumptions or limitations relating to the volume or type of Office support requests covered by that pricing structure.
104	2026-R-038 (RFP) Web Dev 4.pdf; B.7.1, (pp. 3-4)	Is the firm fixed rate the hourly rate for the position?	In accordance with Section L.7.2.1, the contractor shall provide firm-fixed rates for all services, materials, and deliverables, inclusive of approved, fully burdened direct labor rates, travel, per diem, and other direct costs.
105	2026-R-038 (RFP) Web Dev 4.pdf; B.7.1, (pp. 3-4)	Are there descriptions for the lable categories for each CLIN?	Detailed labor category descriptions, including duties and minimum education and experience requirements, shall be proposed by the Offeror as part of the pricing narrative in accordance with Section L.7.2.1.
106	Attachment J-006	Can CPARS be used in lieu of PPQs?	CPARS information may be cited within the technical proposal as supplemental past performance information, however, CPARS does not replace the Past Performance Questionnaire (Attachment J-006) required by Section L.7.1.4.
107	2026-R-038 (RFP) Web Dev 4.pdf; Section C, (pp 3-4)	The solicitation indicates that this is a multiple-award IDIQ contract with a ceiling value but no guaranteed minimum. Could the Government provide an estimated number of IDIQ awards and the anticipated annual volume or typical size of Task Order Proposal Requests (TOPRs) expected to be issued under this contract?	The SAA does not publish the anticipated number of contract awards or the projected volume of TOPRs. Task order volume may vary based on election outcomes, and the scope of individual task orders will depend on the specific requirements of the requesting Office.

108	2026-R-038 (RFP) Web Dev 4.pdf, ; Section L, (p 14)	The solicitation requires submission of a Contractor Cybersecurity Plan (CSP) as part of the Technical Proposal. Please confirm whether the CSP content counts toward the 50-page Technical Proposal limit, or if it may be submitted as a separate appendix.	As part of the technical proposal, the Contractor Cybersecurity Plan (CSP) shall count toward the applicable page limitation.
109	Attachment J-001-A – Senate Web Development Guide (Forms and CSS Integration), (pp 5-6)	The guide indicates that website forms may integrate with Constituent Services Systems (CSS). Will the Government provide standardized API documentation, test environments, and data mapping specifications for CSS integrations during Task Orders? Additionally, who is responsible for coordination with CSS vendors during integration and testing?	The SAA will provide any applicable documentation necessary to support integration with Constituent Services Systems (CSS) at the task order level. Contractors shall be responsible for coordinating directly with the applicable CSS contractors during integration and testing activities.
110	Attachment J-002 – Website Testing and Quality Assurance Requirements (Accessibility), (pp 2-3)	The solicitation requires compliance with Revised Section 508, ADA Title II, and the latest applicable WCAG standards at the time of delivery. Could the Government clarify which WCAG version and conformance level (e.g., WCAG 2.1 AA or WCAG 2.2 AA) will be used as the baseline for accessibility acceptance testing?	In accordance with Section C.3.4.9, the required accessibility delivery standard is WCAG 2.2 Level AA.
111	Sections: C.3.4 Website Design & Development, C.4.2 Design Mockups	How do you approach designing within an existing CMS “base build” while still creating a unique visual identity for each site?	The contractor is responsible for determining the appropriate technical approach to implementing website visual customization. In most cases, this is accomplished through the use of approved site builder plugins, such as Elementor or Divi, as identified in Attachment J-001-A. These approved tools may be used to support customization of the website’s visual identity, including brand colors, typography, navigation headers, footers, and other reusable design components.
112	Sections: C.3.4 Website Design & Development, C.4.2 Design Mockups	How do you balance Senate branding requirements with an individual office’s identity and messaging?	The Senate does not prescribe branding requirements for Office websites. Office identity, color palette, typography, imagery, and messaging shall be developed by the Office in coordination with the contractor during the design phase of the project.
113	Sections: C.3.4 Website Design & Development, C.4.2 Design Mockups	How is consistency across templates, components, and content types handled?	The contractor is responsible for determining the implementation approach using approved plugins. That approach, together with all other aspects of the website, must be approved by the Office point of contact (POC) prior to launch.
114	Sections: C.3.4 Website Design & Development, C.4.2 Design Mockups	What usability testing methods are currently applied during the design phase of Senate digital services, and at what stages of the design process are they typically implemented?	Usability testing methodologies are at the contractor’s discretion. Design phase decisions and practices will be validated through Office POC review of design mockups pursuant to Section C.4.2 and through pre-launch Technical Quality Assurance (TQA) in accordance with Attachment J-002.
115	(Sections: B.4 Pricing, C.3.1.9 Task Order Proposal Requirements, B.7.1 CLIN Structure)	How do we develop cost estimates for website design and development projects based on varying scopes and requirements?	Cost estimates shall be developed for each TOPR using the firm-fixed labor rates set forth in Section B.7.1, as applied to the Offeror’s projected level of effort for the scope specified in the applicable task order.
116	(Sections: B.4 Pricing, C.3.1.9 Task Order Proposal Requirements, B.7.1 CLIN Structure)	How should we account for uncertainty or evolving requirements when preparing initial budgets?	Offerors should address uncertainty through clearly stated assumptions, and proposed labor quotes should be submitted as level-of-effort, not-to-exceed cost ceiling estimates. If, after award, an Office requests work that is outside the awarded scope, the contractor shall submit a task order modification request for consideration.
117	(Sections: B.4 Pricing, C.3.1.9 Task Order Proposal Requirements, B.7.1 CLIN Structure)	Should we include our assumptions used to develop cost estimates for the scope of work on a per-year basis?	Cost estimates shall be prepared based on the requirements of the specific task order and the needs of the requesting Office. The Section B pricing table shall reflect the contractor’s fully burdened rate for each applicable CLIN.
118	Section C.3.1.9 - TOPR Specific Proposal and Documentation	For the 8 hours of “Post-Launch Emergency Support,” what are the specific rules for response times? How quickly are we expected to acknowledge a ticket and actually start working on an emergency fix?	The 15-minute human acknowledgement requirement set forth in Section C.3.6.3 applies.
119	Section C.3.4.1 - Website Design and Development	We are assuming there will be a core SAA base theme. Can you confirm if this is built on USWDS or another framework (like Bootstrap)? If it is a proprietary or custom framework, what is the required build process (e.g., Gulp, Webpack, or Vite) to compile assets within the Senate environment?	The SAA will provision the production CMS platform and authorize the use of Senate approved plugins as identified in Attachment J-001-A. The SAA does not maintain or provide a separate core SAA base theme
120	Section C.3.4.1 - Website Design and Development	Based on Attachment J-001-A: What specific limitations or restrictions should we expect during the child theme development process?	Child theme development must comply with the approved plugin list, applicable restrictions on custom code, accessibility requirements under Section C.3.4.9, privacy requirements set forth in Attachment J-001-A regarding User Data Collection, the approved social media platform list, and the prohibition on embedded third-party JavaScript, iFrames, and API calls as specified in Attachments J-001-A and J-001-B. Any custom child theme must receive SAA approval prior to installation on the Senate network. The review and approval process may take up to six (6) months.
121	Section C.3.4.1.1 - Website Design and Development	Since we can’t move code from our own networks onto the Senate network, can you describe the approved WordPress build and deployment process? Does the Senate core setup and network allow for Composer/Bedrock workflows, and is there a Git repository and CI/CD pipeline (like GitLab or Jenkins) for moving code between environments?	The SAA will provision the production CMS platform and authorize the use of Senate approved plugins as identified in Attachment J-001-A. Staging and development environments shall be governed by SAA standards and made available to awarded contractors through the Senate network. Additional technical details will be communicated to awarded contractors after award.
122	Section C.3.4.1.1 - Website Design and Development	What tools are already set up on the Senate-provided equipment? Will we have access to WP-CLI, Composer, Node/NPM for compiling assets, or local dev environments like DDEV?	The SAA will provision and maintain the CMS platform. Staging and development environments shall be governed by SAA standards and made available to awarded contractors through the Senate network. Additional technical details will be communicated post-award
123	Section C.3.4.1.2 - Website Design and Development	Are there already specific plugins or APIs set up in the Senate WordPress base build to send form data to external systems securely, or do we need to build those custom integrations ourselves?	The Senate will provide, as part of the applicable TOPR, any documentation necessary to support integration with the specific Constituent Services System (CSS) used by the requesting Office. Such integrations generally require the transmission of an XML-formatted email body from the web form (e.g. <firstname>Jane</firstname><lastname>Doe</lastname>) to the Office’s designated CSS email address. The contractor shall be responsible for transmitting the required data in the format specified in the TOPR to the designated CSS email address.

124	Section C.3.4.7 - Website Design and Development	For the search requirements, is the Senate Wordpress base build using a specific backend like Solr or Elasticsearch connected via a WordPress plugin (like ElasticPress)? If so, is the SAA managing the search backend infrastructure or is the contractor responsible for configuring the indexes?	Search functionality is expected to be implemented through the CMS. In addition, certain approved plugins may be used to provide enhanced search capabilities, as identified in Attachment J-001-A, Approved Plugins.
125	Section C.3.4.8 - Website Design and Development	Regarding the storage of large assets, does the SAA provide a centralized media storage solution or CDN (e.g., Amazon S3), and are the necessary WordPress plugins (e.g., WP Offload Media) for remote file management already configured in the base build?	The Solicitation does not publish details regarding centralized media storage or remote media plugin configuration within the base build. Offerors should refer to Attachment J-001-A for the current list of approved plugins.
126	Section C.3.4.9 - Website Design and Development	Is the "Senate-provided accessibility test tool" a manual tool we run in a browser, or is it an automated system we can integrate into a testing pipeline?	The Senate provided accessibility testing tool referenced in Attachment J-002 will be made available post-award. The specific tool, together with any related automation or integration approach, will be communicated at task order kickoff or during contractor onboarding, as applicable.
127	Section C.3.5 - Testing and Quality Assurance	Regarding the 30-day "Exception Period" mentioned in Attachment J-002: Does "no cost" support only cover fixing bugs, or does it also include things like training users and handling general support tickets?	The 30-day "Exception Period" applies to no cost remediation of contractor caused defects identified during that period, consistent with Section C.3.8 and Attachment J-002. End-user training and general support requests are separately addressed under the applicable end-user support CLIN and are not included within the Exception Period scope.
128	Section C.3.8 - Defect Remediation	Attachment J-002 lists different defect levels (Critical, Serious, etc.). Are there specific "clocks" or deadlines for how fast we have to fix each type of bug during the testing and exception periods?	Defect level specific response and resolution clocks are not uniformly prescribed in J-002. The 15-minute human acknowledgement requirement set forth in Section C.3.6.3 applies.
129	Section C.3.11 - Cybersecurity Requirements	Attachment J-005 requires NIST Risk Assessments for new plugins. Does the SAA provide a standard assessment form, or is the contractor responsible for drafting full NIST-compliant security documentation for every new plugin request?	A standard SAA-provided NIST risk assessment form is not included in the Solicitation. Contractors should anticipate preparing NIST-compliant security documentation, as applicable, in connection with new plugin requests in accordance with Attachment J-005.
130	Section C.3.11 - Cybersecurity Requirements	Attachment J-005 mentions specific deadlines for patching software. What are the actual required timeframes for patching critical vs. non-critical vulnerabilities?	Offerors should refer to Attachment J-005 for required patching cadence and applicable vulnerability remediation timeframes.
131	L.7.1.1.3 Offeror Relevant Experience	The solicitation states that a Federal contract reference must have been awarded within the past three (3) years to be considered relevant. We are a current Senate website development provider whose Federal contract was awarded more than three (3) years ago but remains active and continuously performed to date. We would like to clarify whether our currently active Senate website development contract would qualify as a relevant contract reference.	Confirmed. A current Senate contract may qualify, provided it satisfies the applicable Solicitation requirements.
132	Attachment J-006	As a current Senate website development provider, we understand that we are required to include the Senate COR as one of our five (5) references and that we are prohibited from directly soliciting Past Performance Questionnaires (Attachment J-006) from individual Member Office customers. We would like to clarify whether the Senate COR is permitted to independently distribute Attachment J-006 to relevant Member Offices on our behalf, with completed questionnaires submitted directly to acquisitions@saa.senate.gov in accordance with the solicitation instructions.	No. The COR is not authorized to independently distribute Attachment J-006 to relevant Member offices.
133	Section I.15	Section I.15 prohibits using Senate data for AI training without express permission. Is the SAA open to the use of Enterprise-tier third-party AI tools (e.g., OpenAI, Cursor) configured with strict zero-data-retention and no-training policies, or alternatively, models hosted entirely on Senate-controlled server hardware?	All development performed under this contract must comply with Section C.3.4.1.1. Use of AI tools must comply with the procedures set forth in Section I.15.
134	Section F.3	Section F.3 states that Contractors must use SAA-furnished equipment. Is the SAA open to contractors utilizing secure Enterprise AI coding assistants (with zero data retention) via API during local development on these laptops, or connecting to an SAA-hosted private AI endpoint within the Senate network?	All development performed under this contract must comply with Section C.3.4.1.1. Use of AI tools must comply with the procedures set forth in Section I.15.
135	Section F.2.2	Section F.2.2 requires the use of approved Senate VPNs. Is the SAA open to allowing approved outbound API calls to securely hosted, zero-retention AI endpoints, or would the SAA prefer to provision custom hardware on Senate servers to host internal AI endpoints?	All development performed under this contract must comply with Section C.3.4.1.1. Use of AI tools must comply with the procedures set forth in Section I.15.
136	Attachment J-001-A	Attachment J-001-A limits design to pre-approved WordPress plugins. Is the SAA open to the use of zero-retention Enterprise AI APIs strictly as backend developer efficiency utilities? If so, to what extent do these external dev-only connections require the standard 6-month security review?	All development performed under this contract must comply with Section C.3.4.1.1. Use of AI tools must comply with the procedures set forth in Section I.15.
137	Section C.3.4.1.4	Section C.3.4.1.4 states the requirement that coding must conform to OWASP Top 10 practices. Is the SAA open to the idea of contractors using zero-retention AI code-review agents or SAA-hosted models to automatically check custom child-theme code in real-time as developers write it?	All development performed under this contract must comply with Section C.3.4.1.1. Use of AI tools must comply with the procedures set forth in Section I.15.
138	Section C.3.8.1	Section C.3.8.1 states the requirement to supply a remediation plan and schedule for identified defects within forty-eight (48) hours. To what extent is the SAA open to contractors using secure, non-training Enterprise APIs or SAA-hosted AI models to parse error logs and draft the initial remediation plan for human review?	All development performed under this contract must comply with Section C.3.4.1.1. Use of AI tools must comply with the procedures set forth in Section I.15.

139	Section C.3.6.6	Section C.3.6.6 states the requirement to provide a Monthly Report detailing the Office's utilization of Website Maintenance and End-user Support hours. Is the SAA open to the idea of zero-retention Enterprise AI APIs being used to automatically parse internal tracking software to generate this report?	All development performed under this contract must comply with Section C.3.4.1.1. Use of AI tools must comply with the procedures set forth in Section I.15.
140	Section C.3.6.3	Section C.3.6.3 states the requirement that Website Maintenance and End-user Support shall include a human acknowledgement of any service request within fifteen (15) minutes. Would the SAA be open to an SAA-hosted AI model instantly triaging requests and prepopulating responses for human review?	All development performed under this contract must comply with Section C.3.4.1.1. Use of AI tools must comply with the procedures set forth in Section I.15.
141	Attachment J-001-A	Attachment J-001-A strictly prohibits embedding third-party API calls. Is the SAA open to API calls made to securely hosted, FedRAMP-certified AI endpoints used solely by developers in the dev environment, provided no API code is pushed to production?	All development performed under this contract must comply with Section C.3.4.1.1. Use of AI tools must comply with the procedures set forth in Section I.15.
142	Section I.11	Section I.11 defines Confidential Information and its non-disclosure. Is the SAA open to zero-retention Enterprise AI APIs or SAA-hosted models processing this information transiently to assist developers? If so, to what extent is this permissible without constituting unauthorized disclosure?	All development performed under this contract must comply with Section C.3.4.1.1. Use of AI tools must comply with the procedures set forth in Section I.15.
143	CLIN 004	For Content Migration (CLIN 004), is the SAA open to the idea of using AI parsing scripts (via zero-retention APIs or SAA-hosted models) to automatically strip unauthorized third-party iframes from legacy content before porting it to the new CMS?	All development performed under this contract must comply with Section C.3.4.1.1. Use of AI tools must comply with the procedures set forth in Section I.15.
144	Section C.3.4.9	Section C.3.4.9 states the requirement to ensure conformance with Section 508, ADA Title II, and the latest WCAG standard. To what extent is the SAA open to SAA-hosted AI vision models or zero-retention APIs being used to automatically generate accurate alt-text for legacy images?	All development performed under this contract must comply with Section C.3.4.1.1. Use of AI tools must comply with the procedures set forth in Section I.15.
145	Section C.3.3.3	Section C.3.3.3 states the requirement to submit a Weekly Status Report detailing goals, accomplishments, and resource allocations. Is the SAA open to the idea of secure Enterprise AI tools summarizing project tracking metrics for these reports, provided no PII is included?	All development performed under this contract must comply with Section C.3.4.1.1. Use of AI tools must comply with the procedures set forth in Section I.15.
146	Attachment J-001-A	Attachment J-001-A requires development to take place within the Senate environment. Is the SAA open to contractors utilizing zero-retention Enterprise AI APIs or SAA-hosted custom hardware to rapidly generate robust dummy WordPress content for testing?	All development performed under this contract must comply with Section C.3.4.1.1. Use of AI tools must comply with the procedures set forth in Section I.15.
147	Section L.7.1.2.1	Section L.7.1.2.1 requires discussing planned management processes. If we propose secure, zero-retention AI methodologies to significantly expedite delivery, to what extent would the SAA be open to evaluating this favorably as a discriminator?	All development performed under this contract must comply with Section C.3.4.1.1. Use of AI tools must comply with the procedures set forth in Section I.15.
148	Section M.5.1.5	Section M.5.1.5 notes that unrealistically low costs or labor hours may be grounds for rejection. If secure AI automation drastically reduces our required labor hours, is the SAA open to accepting this approach, and how should it be justified in the Price Proposal?	All development performed under this contract must comply with Section C.3.4.1.1. Use of AI tools must comply with the procedures set forth in Section I.15.
149	Section I.16	Section I.16 requires the destruction of Senate data upon contract conclusion. If we leverage SAA-hosted AI models or zero-retention third-party APIs, what are the acceptable sanitization protocols for the data processed by these tools?	All development performed under this contract must comply with Section C.3.4.1.1. Use of AI tools must comply with the procedures set forth in Section I.15.
150	Section C.3.9.1	Section C.3.9.1 states the requirement to develop electronic versions of all website documentation needed to use, implement, and maintain the website. To what extent is the SAA open to contractors using secure Enterprise AI endpoints to automatically generate custom, office-specific manuals?	All development performed under this contract must comply with Section C.3.4.1.1. Use of AI tools must comply with the procedures set forth in Section I.15.
151	Section C.3.4.1.2	Section C.3.4.1.2 states the requirement that gathered data elements be formatted and tagged for subsequent delivery to a destination application. Is the SAA open to the idea of utilizing SAA-hosted AI to dynamically map and tag complex datasets to meet this requirement?	All development performed under this contract must comply with Section C.3.4.1.1. Use of AI tools must comply with the procedures set forth in Section I.15.
152	Attachment J-001-B	Attachment J-001-B emphasizes modern responsive design. Would the SAA be open to contractors using secure, API-driven layout generators to rapidly produce the required clickable HTML mockups for office approval?	All development performed under this contract must comply with Section C.3.4.1.1. Use of AI tools must comply with the procedures set forth in Section I.15.
153	Section C.3.6.5	Section C.3.6.5 includes search engine optimization under support requests. Is the SAA open to the integration of secure AI tools (with no training retention) to generate optimal taxonomy and metadata recommendations for Senate staff?	All development performed under this contract must comply with Section C.3.4.1.1. Use of AI tools must comply with the procedures set forth in Section I.15.
154	Section L.7.1.3	Section L.7.1.3 requires the assignment of Key Personnel. If our Key Personnel rely heavily on zero-retention AI APIs to handle a larger volume of concurrent task orders, to what extent is the SAA open to this leveraged staffing model?	All development performed under this contract must comply with Section C.3.4.1.1. Use of AI tools must comply with the procedures set forth in Section I.15.
155	Section I.15	Section I.15 states contractors have no right to reproduce Senate data in any AI technology. Is the SAA open to the idea of using AI tools strictly for secure code refactoring, provided they have zero data retention and do not train on Senate data?	All development performed under this contract must comply with Section C.3.4.1.1. Use of AI tools must comply with the procedures set forth in Section I.15.
156	Section C.3.1.9	Section C.3.1.9 requires a Firm-Fixed-Price or Labor-Hour proposal for task orders. Is the SAA open to proposals that front-load secure AI automation setup costs into fixed rates while drastically reducing long-term labor hours?	All development performed under this contract must comply with Section C.3.4.1.1. Use of AI tools must comply with the procedures set forth in Section I.15.

157	Section C.3.5	Section C.3.5 states the requirement to perform Website Testing and Quality Assurance to ensure components function as desired. To what extent is the SAA open to the idea of AI-powered visual regression testing tools powered by zero-retention APIs to automatically detect layout shifts?	All development performed under this contract must comply with Section C.3.4.1.1. Use of AI tools must comply with the procedures set forth in Section I.15.
158	Section I.13	Section I.13 requires commercially reasonable disaster recovery and security plans. If we utilize an AI strategy based on SAA-hosted infrastructure or FedRAMP-certified zero-retention APIs, is the SAA open to this, and how can we align it with the SAA's cybersecurity SOPs?	All development performed under this contract must comply with Section C.3.4.1.1. Use of AI tools must comply with the procedures set forth in Section I.15.
159	Section C.3.7.1	Section C.3.7.1 states extended maintenance requests over 5 hours require a written proposal. If AI automation reduces a previously 10-hour complex task to 2 hours, is the SAA open to waiving the formal proposal requirement for these specific tasks?	All development performed under this contract must comply with Section C.3.4.1.1. Use of AI tools must comply with the procedures set forth in Section I.15.
160	Attachment J-001-A	Attachment J-001-A states custom code can only be used when WordPress or approved plugins cannot perform a function. Is the SAA open to secure AI-driven scripts that drastically improve CMS management efficiency? If so, what is the approval process?	All development performed under this contract must comply with Section C.3.4.1.1. Use of AI tools must comply with the procedures set forth in Section I.15.
161	Section I.12	Section I.12 prohibits the disclosure of Senate Data outside of the Contractor except as directed. Is the SAA open to secure AI tools logging basic usage metrics (without retaining data content) for internal performance auditing?	All development performed under this contract must comply with Section C.3.4.1.1. Use of AI tools must comply with the procedures set forth in Section I.15.
162	Section C.3.2	Section C.3.2 states the requirement to measure and evaluate progress against the approved project plan. To what extent is the SAA open to the idea of AI-based project management tools deployed via secure APIs to dynamically track these metrics?	All development performed under this contract must comply with Section C.3.4.1.1. Use of AI tools must comply with the procedures set forth in Section I.15.
163	L.7.1.4 Section 4 – Past Performance	Could the government confirm, if we are allowed to utilize CPARS in lieu of past performance questionnaires to be completed by our relevant agency customers?	CPARS information may be cited within the technical proposal as supplemental past performance information, however, CPARS does not replace the Past Performance Questionnaire (Attachment J-006) required by Section L.7.1.4.
164	L.7.1.4 Section 4 – Past Performance	Please confirm whether the 5 Past Performances used for the Questionnaires (Attachment J-006) must be the same as the 5 used for the Website information (Attachment J-007).	Confirmed.
165	Section B.7.1	Can the government provide full time equivalent (FTE) annual hours for each position proposed under the IDIQ and underlying task orders	No. Task order volume may vary based on election outcomes, and the level of effort for each task order will depend on the specific requirements of the requesting Office.
166	Section B.7.1	Will the government provide the labor category composition and estimated level of effort for labor hour and firm fixed price CLINs 001 – 005?	No. Task order volume may vary based on election outcomes, and level of effort will depend on Office-specific requirements. Labor category composition is at the Offeror's discretion and should be addressed in the pricing narrative included in the administrative volume.
167	Section B.7.1	Will the government provide labor categories description such as education, experience, etc. to ensure contractors provide best value service?	Detailed labor category descriptions, including duties and minimum education and experience requirements, shall be proposed by the Offeror as part of the pricing narrative in accordance with Section L.7.2.1.
168	Section B.7.1	Will the government confirm that the level of effort CLIN 001 – 005 will be similar as and when the task orders are issued, such as duration, labor composition, and FTE count?	No. Level of effort, period of performance, labor mix, and staffing levels will vary based on the specific Office requirements identified in the applicable TOPR.
169	B.3	Can the SAA clarify whether there is an anticipated number of IDIQ contract awards planned, or a target range? Understanding the competitive pool size would help offerors calibrate their pricing and staffing plans.	Awards will be made to all Offerors determined eligible for award under the best-value tradeoff methodology set forth in Section M.
170	B.5	If the base period commences 'on or about January 1, 2027,' is there an anticipated award date or timeline for contract execution that offerors should plan around for staffing and resource availability?	Task orders may be issued as early as January 4, 2027. Accordingly, the SAA anticipates issuing contract awards by the end of calendar year 2026.
171	B.8	Given the \$5,637,600 contract ceiling and no guaranteed minimum, can the SAA provide historical data on the average number and dollar value of Task Orders issued under the current or predecessor web development contract(s)?	The SAA does not publish the anticipated number of awards or projected TOPR volume. Task order volume may vary based on election outcomes, and individual project scope will depend on Office-specific requirements.
172	C.3.11.3	Attachment J-004 (Senate Supported Software List) is referenced but not included. Can the SAA provide this attachment or identify the key development technologies and frameworks currently supported?	Attachment J-004, Senate Supported Software List, was included with the Solicitation package.
173	C.3.4.1.1	The solicitation states all development must be conducted on the Senate network. Can the SAA describe the development environment (e.g., staging servers, version control systems, CI/CD tools) available to contractors?	The SAA shall provision and maintain the CMS platform. Staging and development environments shall be governed by SAA standards and made available to awarded contractors through the Senate network. Additional technical details will be provided post-award.
174	C.3.1.3	For Task Order Proposal Requests (TOPRs), what is the typical response window given to IDIQ contract holders to prepare and submit proposals?	Contractors are typically provided 14 calendar days to submit a proposal in response to a TOPR. In limited circumstances, such as funding deadline urgencies, the response period may be shortened.
175	C.3.1.4	Can the SAA clarify the evaluation criteria used by Senate Offices when selecting among TOPR proposals? Is it lowest price, best value, or at the Office's discretion?	Task order award decisions will be based on the requesting Office's preferences and requirements.
176	C.3.6.3	The 15-minute human acknowledgment SLA for maintenance requests applies during business hours (9 AM-6 PM ET). Is there any expected after-hours support obligation beyond the 8 hours of Post-Launch Emergency Support, and if so, what are the response time expectations?	The 15-minute human acknowledgement SLA applies during normal business hours.

177	C.3.10	For Substantive Website Revisions (30+ cumulative hours), the SAA may issue a competitive TOPR. Can the SAA clarify whether the incumbent maintenance contractor receives any preference or right of first refusal on these revisions?	Once the Senate elects to issue a competitive TOPR for a Substantive Website Revision, all contract holders are eligible to submit a task order proposal. The requesting Office will determine the contractor to which the task order will be issued. The incumbent maintenance contractor will not receive preference or a right of first refusal.
178	H.3	Can the SAA clarify the typical timeline for background check processing and approval? Understanding this lead time is critical for staffing proposals and onboarding schedules.	In accordance with Section H.4.3.2, personnel security processing requires a minimum lead time of two weeks.
179	F.2	How many concurrent Senate Office website projects should offerors be prepared to support simultaneously under this contract?	The volume of concurrent website projects will vary depending on the number of task orders awarded to an individual contractor.
180	B.7.1	For CLIN 005 (Website Maintenance and End-User Support, FFP monthly rate), should the monthly rate assume a specific number of support hours per month, or is this intended as a retainer regardless of volume?	Monthly rates for ongoing maintenance and end-user support CLINs shall be calculated based on the projected monthly level of effort multiplied by the fully burdened fixed rate for the applicable labor category and proposed as a firm-fixed monthly amount in accordance with Section B.7.1. Contractors should describe the level of service included in their monthly support program and identify any limitations related to the volume or nature of Office support requests.
181	L.6	The Technical Proposal page limit is 50 pages. Are appendices, table of contents, cover pages, and section dividers counted within the 50-page limit, or only substantive narrative content?	Section L.6 identifies the materials excluded from the proposal page limitation. All other proposal content is subject to the applicable page limitation.
182	I.15	Section I.15 prohibits use of Senate data for AI training. Can the SAA clarify whether this prohibition extends to the use of AI-assisted development tools (e.g., code completion, automated testing) during website development, provided no Senate data is used for model training?	All development performed under this contract must comply with Section C.3.4.1.1. Use of AI tools must comply with the procedures set forth in Section I.15.
183	General Comment	Are incumbent contractors on the current web development contract eligible to compete for this solicitation? If so, can the SAA identify the current contract holders?	Incumbent contractors are eligible to submit proposals in response to this Solicitation; however, the Senate will not provide incumbent contract information.
184	C.3.4.1.1	The RFP states all development must be conducted on the Senate network. Are contractors provided remote VPN access to the Senate development environment, or must all development work be performed on-site at Senate facilities?	Remote performance is permitted and anticipated under this requirement. There are no on-site performance requirements.
185	F.2 / F.2.2	Section F.2.2 requires contractors to access Senate systems only using Senate-provided equipment and VPNs. Are contractors expected to have personnel physically located in the Washington, DC metro area, or can work be performed remotely from other locations using Senate-provided equipment?	Remote performance is permitted and anticipated under this requirement. There are no on-site performance requirements.
186	C.3.4	While the Senate as a Legislative Branch entity is not subject to Executive Branch mandates, the 21st Century Integrated Digital Experience Act (IDEA Act) and OMB M-23-22 (Delivering a Digital-First Public Experience) have established widely recognized best practices for government website design, accessibility, and user experience. Has the SAA adopted any of the IDEA Act's goals or OMB M-23-22 guidelines as voluntary standards for Senate Office websites, and should offerors reference these frameworks in their technical approach?	Offerors may reference these standards in their proposals, however, adoption of such standards is not required by the Solicitation.
187	C.3.4	The U.S. Web Design System (USWDS) has become the de facto standard for federal government websites, providing accessible, mobile-friendly components and design patterns. Do Senate Office websites currently utilize USWDS components, or has the SAA considered adoption of USWDS (in whole or in part) as a design foundation? If not currently in use, would the SAA be receptive to offerors proposing USWDS-aligned approaches where they enhance accessibility and usability?	Any proposals submitted and any development or support services performed under this contract must comply with all applicable contract requirements. Offerors should refer to Attachments J-001-A and J-001-B for additional information. The contractor is ultimately responsible for delivering the requested Office website services within the approved budget and schedule, and in accordance with applicable industry best practices.
188	C.3.4	Many federal digital properties integrate with shared services such as Search.gov (for site search) and the Digital Analytics Program (DAP) for web analytics. Do Senate Office websites currently integrate with Search.gov or DAP?	Offerors should refer to Attachments J-001-A and J-001-B for information regarding approved analytics tools and other applicable development requirements under this contract.
189	C.3.4.9	The solicitation requires conformance with Section 508, ADA Title II, and the latest WCAG standards. OMB M-23-22 goes further by establishing digital experience benchmarks such as mobile responsiveness, plain language, consistent visual design, and customer satisfaction measurement. Beyond the stated accessibility requirements, has the SAA established any additional digital experience performance standards or metrics (e.g., page load time targets, mobile usability scores, reading-level requirements) that contractors should design to?	Offerors should refer to Attachments J-001-A and J-001-B for information regarding approved analytics tools and other applicable development requirements under this contract.
190	C.3.11	The IDEA Act encourages agencies to modernize toward shared, standards-based technology platforms. Is the SAA planning any CMS modernization or migration during the period of performance of this contract (2027-2032), and should offerors factor potential platform evolution into their technical approach and staffing plans?	Offerors shall base their technical approach and staffing plans on the requirements set forth in the Solicitation.

191	L.7.1.1.3	Section L.7.1.1.3 instructs Offerors to select website projects designed using the 'targeted CMS.' Please confirm that the 'targeted CMS' referenced in this section is WordPress, consistent with Attachment J-001-A and J-001-B.	Confirmed.
192	L.7.1.3 / M.5.1.4 / H.3	Section M.5.1.4 references 'minimum key areas defined in Sections L and H.3' for Key Personnel evaluation. Please identify the specific minimum Key Personnel roles the SAA requires Offerors to propose (e.g., Program Manager, Technical Lead, etc.), or confirm that the Offeror has discretion to define Key Personnel roles.	The Solicitation does not prescribe specific Key Personnel labor categories or position titles. Offerors are responsible for identifying and designating proposed Key Personnel, which will be evaluated in accordance with Section M.5.1.4.
193	B.7.1	Section B.7.1 lists five CLINs with a single rate column per CLIN per period. If the Offeror intends to utilize Subcontractors, the solicitation states rates shall be a 'composite price/rate.' Should the Offeror provide a single blended rate per CLIN that covers all labor categories (e.g., developer, designer, PM), or does the SAA expect labor category-level rate breakdowns within the Price Proposal narrative?	Offerors shall propose a single blended rate for each CLIN. Labor category breakdowns are not required.
194	C.3.4.9 / J-001-B	Section C.3.4.9 requires conformance with 'the latest WCAG standard applicable at delivery.' Please confirm whether the current applicable standard is WCAG 2.1 AA or WCAG 2.2 AA, and whether the SAA anticipates updating this requirement during the contract period of performance.	In accordance with Section C.3.4.9, the required accessibility delivery standard is WCAG 2.2 Level AA.
195	C.3.4.1.1 / F.2	Section C.3.4.1.1 states that all development must be conducted on the Senate network and off-network development cannot be ported to the Senate network. Section F.2 states work shall be performed at the Contractor's site(s) and Senate facilities. Please clarify whether Contractor personnel may perform on-network development remotely via Senate-provided VPN and equipment from Contractor facilities outside the Washington, DC metropolitan area.	Remote performance is permitted and anticipated under this requirement. There are no on-site performance requirements.
196	B.8 / C.2	Section B.8 establishes a contract ceiling of \$5,637,600 per IDIQ and no guaranteed minimum. Can the SAA provide the approximate number of IDIQ contracts it anticipates awarding, and the approximate number of Task Order Proposal Requests (TOPRs) issued under the predecessor contract(s) per year?	The SAA does not publish the anticipated number of contract awards or projected TOPR volume. Task order volume may vary based on election outcomes, and individual project scope will depend on Office-specific requirements.
197	Section: B - Supplies or Services and Price/Costs	Plugin Usage: Are there any exceptions for additional plugins beyond those listed, or is the provided list exhaustive for all potential needs?	Contractors may request that additional plugins be considered for inclusion on the Senate-approved plugin list. However, contractors shall not include or rely upon plugins that are not already on the Senate-approved list in task order proposals.
198	Section: C - Statement of Work	Custom Code: If custom code is required, what is the process for obtaining approval, and are there examples of scenarios where it would be justified?	The Senate does not anticipate requirements for which no approved plugin solution is available. However, if a contractor determines that no Senate-approved plugin can satisfy a requirement, the contractor may submit a written request to the COR describing the requirement, the insufficiency of currently approved plugins, the absence of an available plugin that could be added to the approved list, and the nature of the proposed custom code. The COR will review the request and determine whether the contractor may propose the custom-code approach to the requesting Office. The Office retains final discretion to accept or decline the proposed solution.
199	Section: C - Statement of Work	Cybersecurity Risk Assessment: Could you confirm the required timelines for cybersecurity assessments for third-party tools, and whether this is a one-time or ongoing requirement throughout the contract period?	Cybersecurity risk assessment timelines are not fixed. Contractors shall not rely on completion of a cybersecurity risk assessment for purposes of task order proposal timing or project schedule commitments. Risk assessments are an ongoing requirement, and SAA Cybersecurity may require additional assessments of previously reviewed items during the contract period.
200	Section: D - Packaging and Marking	Delivery Locations: Are there any specific delivery requirements for certain locations within Senate offices that differ from the general guidelines (e.g., for events)?	Delivery locations are not expected to be relevant to Office TOPR requirements; however, they will apply to the return of Senate-Furnished Equipment. Additional instructions will be provided to contractors when equipment return is required.
201	Section M.1 - Basis for Contract Award	Are there any incumbents, if yes then how many? How many awards will be made?	This procurement is the fourth iteration of a multi-award IDIQ contract with multiple incumbent vendors. The SAA does not disclose information regarding incumbent vendors.
202	General Question	If Offices are on WD3, will they be migrated to WD4 by default? What is the plan to support both WD3 and WD4?	Existing websites developed under prior iterations of the contract may be supported under the new contract iteration where the applicable contract line items are the same.
203	General Question	Will Contractors continue to receive Office feedback providing insight into why the awarded Contractor was selected for a TOPR? Please clarify where this option is specifically addressed/located within the IDIQ or TOPR.	Subject to the permission of the awarding Office, the Senate may provide applicable feedback regarding the basis for a task order award decision. This process is not specifically addressed in the contract or TOPRs.
204	B.7.1 Schedule for Contract Line -Item Numbers (CLINs)	Regarding CLINs 005,105, 205, 305,405, & 505, would it be acceptable to limit our offering to include limiting language such as "not to exceed xx number of hours per month for fixed price support plans"?	No. Offerors may not limit the number of support hours offered under monthly support. If an Office requests end-user assistance outside the identified scope of potential end-user support services, or if the request meets the threshold for an extended maintenance request, the contractor shall follow the extended maintenance request process. Such requests are invoiced on an hourly basis.
205	F.3 Senate Furnished Property AND H.12 Senate Furnished Equipment/Contractor Furnished Equipment	Please define what is considered a reasonable amount of time to expect CFEs after a Contractor has been approved by security?	Section F.3 refers to Senate-Furnished Equipment (SFE), not contractor-furnished equipment. SFE will be issued to contractors as necessary to perform and deliver services under the contract.
206	L.3. Date and Time of Closing	Would the SAA please consider extending the deadline for submission by two (2) weeks from the date questions are answered?	No extension to the proposal deadline will be provided.

207	2026-R-038 (RFP) Web Dev 4, L.7.1.1.3 Offeror Relevant Experience (P. 50), states "For a contract reference to be considered relevant, the contract must have been awarded within the past three (3) years and must involve products and capabilities most similar to those proposed for performance under this Contract."	Can the government please confirm that a contract with a period of performance that is active and ongoing is also considered relevant even if it was awarded prior to the past three (3) years?	Confirmed.
208	2026-R-038 (RFP) Web Dev 4, Section M.5.1.5 (p. 56) states "the SAA will multiply the Offeror's proposed rates by an SAA-estimated quantity for evaluation purposes."	Will the SAA provide these estimated labor quantities/hours to all Offerors prior to the proposal due date to ensure a level playing field for price competition, or is the SAA evaluating the Offeror's internal estimation of effort?	In accordance with Section M.5.1.5, the SAA will apply the same quantities to all Price Proposals for evaluation purposes. The SAA will not provide estimated labor quantities or hours to Offerors, and Offerors shall not include quantity estimates in their Price Proposals.
209	2026-R-038 (RFP) Web Dev 4, Section L.6 (p. 49) notes that "Resumes, references... are not included in the Technical Proposal page limit."	Does the "Staffing Plan" required in Section L.7.1.3 (p. 51), which must include job categories and minimum qualifications, count toward the 50-page technical limit, or is it considered an attachment?	As part of the technical proposal, the staffing plan is subject to the applicable page limitation.
210	2026-R-038 (RFP) Web Dev 4, Section B.7.1 (p. 3) lists CLINs such as "Website Design and Development (LH)" but does not provide specific Labor Category (LCAT) titles or minimum qualifications.	Will the SAA provide a list of required Labor Categories (e.g., Senior Developer, UX Designer, QA Lead) and their associated minimum experience/education requirements to ensure all Offerors are pricing against the same standards?	Detailed labor category descriptions, including duties and minimum education and experience requirements, shall be proposed by the Offeror as part of the pricing narrative in accordance with Section L.7.2.1.
211	2026-R-038 (RFP) Web Dev 4, Section B.2 (p. 2) states: "Management rights to the site and its content... shall be the sole property of the Senate Office."	Does the Senate's ownership extend to custom-developed plugins or modules created by the Contractor during a Task Order, or is the Contractor permitted to reuse non-proprietary code components across multiple Senate Offices?	The contract does not provide for custom-developed plugins. Contractors are expected to use Senate-approved plugins across Senate Offices, as appropriate to each Office's website requirements.
212	Attachment J-001-B - Senate Web Design Guide	Attachment J-001-B states that WordPress is the only authorized Content Management System (CMS) for websites developed under this contract. However, the Senate web environment appears to support multiple CMS / platform types for different use cases (Drupal, WooCommerce, others). QUESTION: Can the Government clarify whether WordPress is the only CMS authorized for new websites developed under this IDIQ and associated task orders, and confirm whether any other CMS platforms may be authorized for use under specific circumstances or task order requirements?	WordPress is the only CMS application authorized for websites developed or supported under this contract.
213	2026-R-038 (RFP) Web Dev 4, L.7.2.1 Price Section Instructions (p.53) states "Price Proposal shall break out pricing as identified in Section B.7.1" and Offerors are required to "Complete model contract (Solicitation Sections B-J) with costs and other Offeror information inserted in all blanks".	Given the limited space within the Section B.7.1 tables: 1) What information should an Offeror include within the tables? 2) How does the Government want Offerors to provide all their proposed labor categories with fully burdened hourly rates across the five (5) CLINs each contract year?	Offerors shall provide a single, fully burdened rate for each CLIN in the Section B pricing table. In accordance with Section L.7.2.1, Offerors shall include a breakdown of rate derivations in the pricing narrative within the administrative volume.
214	RFP Section L.7.1.3	In "Section 3: Qualifications and Resumes of Proposed Staff," labor categories for Key Personnel are not identified. Will the Senate provide the required LCATs?	The Solicitation does not prescribe specific Key Personnel labor categories or position titles. Offerors shall self-designate Key Personnel, which will be evaluated in accordance with Section M.5.1.4.
215	RFP Section M.5.1.3	In "Section 4: Past Performance," past performances are required to have been performed within the last three years. Since five past performances are required, could the requirement be extended to contracts performed within the last five years?	The three-year period specified in Section M.5.1.3 is the applicable requirement. Contracts that are currently active and ongoing qualify regardless of original award date.